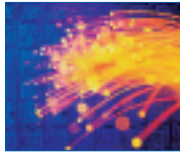


New Fibre-line Connects USA And China

A 18,000 km high capacity fibre-optic line under the Pacific Ocean was completed. The total cost for the project was \$500 million and will serve China, Taiwan, South Korea the most. AT&T and NTT Communications from Japan and have joined hands for this project



Falcon1 By SpaceX Takes Flight

In what is a milestone development, the Falcon1 by SpaceX became the first privately manufactured space vehicle to orbit the Earth. The Falcon1 managed this feat after three failed attempts, and just when the prospects were looking bleak indeed



Enter



Paul Murphy, Director, Innovation, Microsoft (India), the person evangelising Microsoft's "Indian Innovation Story"

What is the Innovation accelerator programme?

The Imagine Cup Innovation Accelerator Programme was started with the aspiration of enabling a few of the high potential projects that can come of the innovation accelerator programme and giving them an opportunity to see some commercial viability. It is started not in this year only. Over a period of few weeks we take several finalists and we incubate them, they get trained and coaching, specifically around the idea of Imagine Cup student competition and changing it into a business. Imagine Cup has grown considerably almost twice every year, last year 1,85,000 students participated globally in it, 18,000 to 19,000 participants were from India, when we look at the talent in India and all of these things say that India has the potential to be one the best in this world.

What are your aspirations for the Innovation Accelerator programme?

Aspiration for next year is to exponentially increase. How we do it is a two step process, first make sure competition exists, and second is to make sure that they have the right resources so that as they enter they have everything they need to be successful. We are doing massive branding and marketing exercise to invite more and more participation too.

What should budding software engineering aspirants need to do to be noticed by Microsoft?

The imagine cup or the Imagine Cup Innovation Accelerator Programme, neither of these are recruitment vehicles for Microsoft, we are interested in how we can help India to become a stronger knowledge nation economy.

ANDROID IS HERE

Google Unveils The G1

On September 23, Google, HTC and T-Mobile unveiled their long anticipated G1 phone at a press conference in New York. The G1 will be available with the service provider T-Mobile, is manufactured by HTC and runs on the Android platform which is an open source Linux OS.

The importance of this device is two-fold, firstly, the phone is placed in direct competition to the iPhone, is more feature-rich and is much cheaper. Second, and more importantly, the G1 is a step towards the visionary future of Google computing, where the OS, the widgets, the applications, and all the interaction is centred around Google. The G1 blurs the line between what a cell-phone does and the Internet. There is a single button to search through the phone and the Internet,

which is useful as it is possible to search for the phone numbers of people through the search engine in America. Instant messaging is available through both the network and gtalk. The browser used for navigating the Web allows for tabbed browsing, and is called Chrome Lite. The phone comes bundled with software to keep track of your carbon footprint, to compare prices from different stores in real time, and many others. Since the operating system is open source, any kind of application can be put in by the user, and is "future-proof" according to Google. The G1 ties in with Google Maps and Street View, it is possible to use the device to look at panoramic images at street level.

As far as specs go, there is a 320x480 touch screen, a sliding QWERTY keyboard, and a trackball for navigation, which makes the G1 more accessible than the iPhone. The phone has WiFi, 3D graphics acceleration and a 3 MP camera. The phone allows for 350 minutes of talk time, and 402 hours of standby on 3G.

The phones are available in brown, black

and white. Their prices will depend on the subscription plan. The G1 will be sold from October 24 in the states, from November in the United Kingdom, and early next year, it will be available all over Europe.

TERROR FALLOUT

BMC's Wi-Fi Plans In Trouble

BMC (Mumbai's municipal corporation) has been planning to make a city wide open Wi-Fi network available for some time now. The project, if implemented, would put Mumbai at par with cities like Houston and Philadelphia, which have city-wide wireless networks. The plan would not only allow users to connect to the Internet wirelessly for basic services, it would also enable better e-governance and e-commerce. Moreover, the Wi-Fi infrastructure would be used to monitor streetlights, electricity stations and water meters, saving a lot of cabling and adding considerably to the city's carbon credits.

However, this gracious plan on the side of the BMC, has been put on the tenterhooks by the

